

Understand Technical Work Without Reading Code

Session 20 | Product and Delivery Teams | Beginner

GitHub Copilot is required

Before the session:

- sign in with an approved GitHub account;
- open GitHub Copilot Chat;
- submit a test prompt;
- confirm Copilot returns a response.

Stop if access fails. Resolve the account, license, policy, or service issue before continuing.

Your job is to make a sound decision

You do not need to explain the implementation.

Use GitHub Copilot to question the supplied evidence and judge:

- what changes for users;
- what could go wrong;
- what remains unknown;
- who must review the decision.

Use an evidence chain

Artifact	What it can tell you
Repository overview	Product purpose and system boundaries
Issue	Intended problem, scope, and acceptance criteria
Pull request	Proposed implementation and stated validation
Diff evidence	Specific behavior changed
Checks	What automated validation ran and its result
Human review	Context, judgment, and approval ownership

No single artifact tells the whole story.

Ask business questions

- Which user journey changes?
- What behavior is new, removed, or altered?
- Which acceptance criteria have evidence?
- What could block release or create support load?
- Which claim needs a specialist to confirm?

Avoid broad prompts such as "Is this safe?"

Separate claims by evidence state

State	Meaning
Verified	Directly supported by a named artifact
Inferred	Reasonable conclusion, not directly proven
Generated	Suggested by an AI summary and not yet checked
Unknown	Evidence is missing or contradictory

Generated does not mean false. It means **check it**.

A summary is a map, not proof

GitHub Copilot can answer questions about repository and pull request context.

Use the answer to find likely files, checks, risks, and follow-up questions. Then inspect the cited artifact or ask the accountable owner.

Read checks as evidence with limits

Passed means the configured check completed successfully.

It does not prove:

- every user path was tested;
- skipped tests are harmless;
- rollout and support plans are ready;
- the business requirement is correct.

Escalate when the decision exceeds your evidence

Signal	Escalate to
Security, identity, or permission behavior	Security or engineering owner
Personal or regulated data	Privacy or compliance owner
Accessibility evidence missing	Accessibility or UX owner
Failed, skipped, or absent release checks	Engineering or release owner
Requirement and implementation disagree	Product owner and engineering lead

Escalation is a decision, not a failure.

Lab deliverable

Write a one-page product impact and risk brief for the Service Request Portal change.

Use GitHub Copilot to analyze and question the synthetic evidence.

Include:

1. decision and confidence;
2. user and product impact;
3. verified evidence;
4. risks and unknowns;
5. review boundary and next action.

Review standard

A strong brief is traceable.

Another person can identify:

- which artifact supports each material claim;
- which statements remain uncertain;
- why the work should proceed, pause, or change.